DOCUMENT 03 · VALIDATION POLICY

Validation policy

When an AI response is invalid and must be discarded even if it looks good: the five causes, what does not invalidate, the procedure and the record that each decision leaves

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invalidation causes	validation priorities	steps in the procedure	invalid responses that are reused

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01

Purpose and nature

This policy establishes when an AI response, in any SPAD phase, is considered **invalid** and must be discarded, regardless of its apparent quality.

It is a **human governance policy**, not an instruction for the AI:

It is	It is not
A set of rules applied by the person orchestrating.	A text that the AI interprets or executes.

It is	It is not
The process control over the AI's work.	A technical review of the result (that is done by the AI Reviewer and by the human code review).
Mandatory in all SPAD work, complete or reduced.	Optional or proportional.

02

Fundamental principle

> In SPAD, **workflow compliance is more important than result quality**.

A technically correct response that violates its phase **is not accepted, is not partially reused and is not corrected**: it is discarded in its entirety and the phase is executed again from scratch.

Priority	Criterion
1	Process compliance
2	Technical correctness
3	Efficiency

> **Why it matters.** Accepting "just this once" a response that breaks the rules because the code works destroys the process in two steps: the AI learns that it can skip the phase and the person loses the reference of what is valid. The discipline of discarding and repeating is what makes the artefacts reliable and the traceability real. A valid NO-GO is always better than an invalid GO.

03

Invalidation causes

3.1 Phase violation

The response executes actions that do not correspond to the active phase.

Phase	Violation	Why it is invalid
PLAN	Generates or modifies code; proposes concrete fixes.	The plan defines, it does not implement.
Plan review	Corrects or rewrites the plan.	The AI Reviewer evaluates, it does not fix.
Code primer	Introduces new design decisions.	The primer translates the plan, it does not change it.
Implementation	Takes design decisions.	The AI Builder follows decisions, it does not take them.
Code review	Corrects or rewrites code.	The AI Reviewer evaluates, it does not fix.
Fixes	Redesigns, refactors or extends functionality.	Minimal fixes only.
Diagnosis	Generates solution code; modifies production code.	It produces a root cause report, not solutions.

Action: discard the response and execute the same phase again. If it recurs, record the violation.

3.2 Missing or altered artefacts

The response omits mandatory sections, does not include the required markers or alters the contractual format (document 07).

Examples: a plan without the risks section; a review without an explicit verdict; a test strategy without minimum coverage; a version without a semantic number; a root cause report without a verdict; any artefact without the model record.

Action: discard and execute the phase again, insisting on the mandatory sections.

3.3 Off-plan decisions

The response introduces technical decisions not documented in the approved plan, unauthorised scope changes or undeclared assumptions, **even if they are well reasoned**.

Examples: the implementation adds a caching layer that the plan does not provide for; it changes the data schema; integration tests appear where only unit tests were planned; a fix refactors an entire module.

Action: discard; return to the plan (or to the fix plan, if the change is minor and the person accepts it as an iteration); record the unauthorised decision.

3.4 Implementation without prior review

Code is generated or modified when no approved plan exists, the plan review or the code review has not been executed, or a previous review returned NO-GO and implementation proceeds anyway.

Action: discard all the generated code and return to the correct phase. If that code were to reach production within a SEVEN-G initiative, it is a **major nonconformity** (SEVEN-G 53, section 6).

3.5 Self-approval

The response approves itself, minimises violations or justifies non-compliance.

Examples: "I made some changes to the plan, but they are minor"; "I know I was not supposed to include code, but I am adding an example"; "the review found three issues, but I am marking them as GO"; "I implemented X instead of Y because it is better".

Action: immediate discard; execute again with strengthened constraints; consider it a **critical violation** in the log.

> **Why it matters.** Self-approval is the most serious cause because it directly attacks the segregation of duties: if it is tolerated, the AI Reviewer ceases to be a review and becomes a formality.

04

What does not invalidate a response

Situation	Valid	Reason
The review returns NO-GO.	Yes	The review is working.
The security review finds critical vulnerabilities.	Yes	That is why we review.
Tests fail on the first implementation.	Yes	Expected iteration.
Code that works but is not elegant, within its phase.	Yes	It is improved in fixes if the review flags it.
Minor style inconsistencies.	Yes	Likewise.

Situation	Valid	Reason
A reasonable technical opinion within the scope of the phase.	Yes	It is part of the work.
A conservative assessment of a risk.	Yes	Better safe than sorry.
The AI declares a deviation and does not execute it, asking for a decision.	Yes	It is the correct behaviour when the plan has a gap.

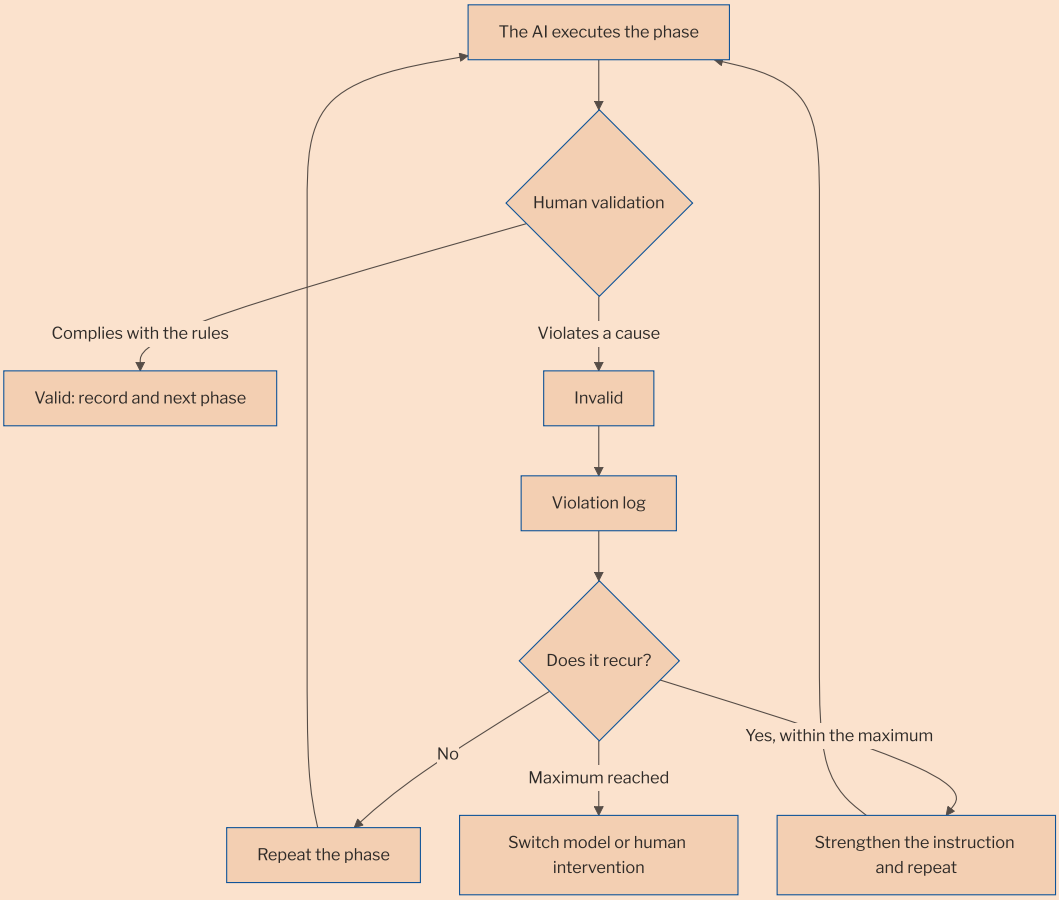
05

Procedure when a response is invalid

Step	Action
1 · Recognise	Identify that the response violates one of the five causes.
2 · Do not correct	Do not edit the response, do not reuse parts of it, do not ask the AI to "fix" it.
3 · Discard	Treat the entire response as if it did not exist. It is kept in the topic's register as a rejected iteration, marked as invalid.
4 · Repeat	Execute the same phase with the same instruction.
5 · Strengthen	If the violation recurs: make the prohibitions explicit in the instruction, add examples of what is not admitted, tighten the review, record the pattern.
6 · Escalate	After the maximum number of attempts set in the global context (starting value: three), switch model, have a person intervene or document the limitation of the methodology for that case.

Validation of each phase

The person validates; what is invalid is recorded and repeated



Source: SPAD

06

Validation record and violation log

Every validation leaves a record (document 02, section 4.2), and every invalidation, in addition, an entry in the violation log:

Field	Content
Date and topic	When and in which piece of work.
Phase	The active phase.
Cause	One of the five (3.1 to 3.5).
Model	Provider, model and version that produced the response.

Field	Content
Action	Repeated · Strengthened · Escalated.
Outcome	On which attempt a valid response was obtained, or whether it was escalated.

Illustrative example of a log.

Date	Topic	Phase	Cause	Model	Action	Outcome
11-02-2026	`payment_gateway`	PLAN	Phase violation (code in the plan)	Provider A, model 4, v2026-01	Repeated	Valid on the second attempt
11-02-2026	`user_auth`	Code review	Self-approval with open findings	Provider B, model 3.5	Strengthened	Valid on the third attempt after tightening the instruction

> **Why it matters.** The log turns the policy into learning: it shows which phases fail most, which models follow the rules worst and which instructions need strengthening. It is the basis of the process metrics (document 08) and, in organisations that apply SEVEN-G, it feeds the lessons learned and the assessment of the AI provider.

07

Governance rules

Rule	Detail
Authority	Validation decisions are final and are taken by the person orchestrating. When in doubt, invalidate.
Independence	No AI validates its own output; the AI Reviewer's outputs are validated by a person, not by the AI Builder.
Documentation	Every invalidation is recorded. In work under the reduced version, at least cause, phase and date.
Continuous improvement	If a phase exceeds the invalidation rate set in the global context (starting value: 30 %), the instruction is reviewed. If a model violates the rules systematically, it is switched. The policy is reviewed in the light of experience.

08

Examples of decisions

Phase	Output	Decision	Reason
Plan review	"The design does not handle more than one hundred concurrent users. Verdict: NO-GO."	**Valid**	The review is working; work returns to the plan with the observation.
PLAN	Detailed architecture followed by "a sample implementation" of five hundred lines.	**Invalid**	Phase violation. Code quality is irrelevant.
Implementation	Code that follows the plan and the primer, with style inconsistencies.	**Valid**	Within the phase; style is addressed in fixes if the review flags it.
Code review	"Three issues: no error handling, no input validation, a secret in the code. They are minor: GO."	**Invalid**	Self-approval with open findings. Critical violation.
Implementation	"The plan does not say how to handle the retry; I have not implemented it and I am asking for a decision."	**Valid**	Correct behaviour when the plan has a gap: the person decides to return to the plan.

09

Related documents

Document	Relationship
document 01 · Operating guide	Phases, roles and verdicts to which the policy applies.
document 02 · Contexts, topics and artefact register	Validation record and violation log.
document 07 · Input and output contracts	Mandatory sections whose absence invalidates (3.2).
document 08 · Self-assessment and metrics	Invalidation rate and other process metrics.
SEVEN-G 53 · Building solutions with AI	Additional treatment of each cause within SEVEN-G (nonconformities, evidence).

10

Version control

Version	Date	Changes
0.1	19-09-2026	First version. Rewrites the previous policy within the library: human nature of the policy, five causes with actions, what does not invalidate, procedure with maximum number of attempts and invalidation rate as parameters of the global context, validation record and violation log, governance and examples.